

First Read

Tencent Holdings

1Q26 inline; undervalue optionality in a rapidly evolving AI landscape

1Q26 topline missed on CNY seasonality

Revenue +9%, slight missed by 2% (see our [quick take](#)). **Adj. OP/NP** +9%/+11%, inline.

Key focuses

1) AI investment: Designed as a cost-efficient and solid model for practical tasks, mgmt is happy with the performance of HY3, particularly on the fast iteration with the foundation model team rebuilt in late 2025, and its strong integration with Tencent's internal products (token usage at least 10x of HY2). Looking ahead, mgmt expects HY4 feature larger parameters. On monetization, though still at early stage, mgmt would prioritize high-value use cases over DAU growth given high variable inference costs. Mini Programs, which connect millions of third-party merchants, would be Tencent's exclusive edge and a key opportunity to explore.

2) Capex & cloud: Capex expanded to Rmb32bn (4Q25's Rmb20bn). Mgmt has become more affirmative to increase capex in 2026, with a more meaningful ramp in 2H as domestic chip supply improves. This should underpin cloud growth acceleration in 2H with more available chip reallocated for external customers.

3) Core businesses. Games: While domestic games revenue missed at +6% in 1Q, it was mainly due to the delayed CNY which shifted partial revenue recognition beyond 1Q. 1Q grossing at teens YoY; this should offer solid visibility on revenue growth acceleration into the rest of 2026E. Mgmt increasingly sees AI benefits with accelerating production content and monetizable items. International games +13% in 1Q, but growth could decelerate amid Supercell's growth normalization and base effects following the consolidation of Kuro in Dec-24. We forecast Tencent's domestic/international games growth at +14%/+10% for 2026E. **Ads:** Ad growth accelerated to +20% (4Q25's +18%), driven by Video Accounts' higher ad impression (time spent +20% YoY) and ad load (4-5%), ad tech upgrade, and close-looped ads (higher eCPM). That said, the investment in AI Ad model has led to GPM -0.5pp YoY.

All and all, we forecast revenue and OP growth at 12% for 2Q. Factoring in the 2026 new AI investments, we anticipate revenue +11%, GP growth should remain faster at +15%, but adj OP growth could be slightly slower at +10%. Excluding the AI drag, Tencent's adj OP should have +16% YoY for 2026E (1Q's +17%).

What to do with the stock?

Tencent's stock has lagged YTD (-23%; vs. HSTech -8%), largely due to market concerns about its perceived delays in AI investment, a view we find overstated for the following

Equities

China
Internet Services

12-month rating **Buy**

12m price target **HK\$780.00**

Price (13 May 2026) **HK\$462.60**

RIC: 0700.HK BBG: 700 HK

Trading data and key metrics

52-wk range	HK\$677.50-457.20
Market cap.	HK\$4,203b/US\$537b
Shares o/s	9,085m (ORD)
Free float	66%
Avg. daily volume ('000)	26,985
Avg. daily value (m)	HK\$13,620.4
Common s/h equity (12/26E)	Rmb1348b
P/BV (12/26E)	2.7x
Net debt to EBITDA (12/26E)	NM

EPS (UBS, diluted) (Rmb)

	From	To	% ch	Cons.
12/26E	31.39	31.63	1	30.77
12/27E	35.15	34.80	-1	34.33
12/28E	38.56	38.22	-1	38.10

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Highlights (Rmbm)	12/23	12/24	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E	12/29E	12/30E
Revenues	609,015	660,257	751,766	837,327	918,923	995,658	1,077,819	1,167,793
EBIT (UBS)	205,694	253,815	297,565	326,676	365,215	400,243	437,862	479,510
Net earnings (UBS)	157,688	222,703	259,626	289,424	318,495	349,800	383,462	420,681
EPS (UBS, diluted) (Rmb)	16.41	23.67	28.09	31.63	34.80	38.22	41.90	45.97
DPS (net) (Rmb)	3.46	4.57	5.39	6.10	6.72	7.38	8.09	8.87
Net (debt) / cash	13,503	(9,785)	(2,914)	142,226	323,090	531,961	777,351	1,063,107
Profitability/valuation	12/23	12/24	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E	12/29E	12/30E
EBIT (UBS) margin %	33.8	38.4	39.6	39.0	39.7	40.2	40.6	41.1
ROIC (EBIT) %	34.3	37.2	35.8	35.9	39.1	42.2	45.8	50.4
EV/EBITDA (UBS core) x	10.1	9.3	12.0	8.2	7.4	6.7	6.0	5.4
P/E (UBS, diluted) x	18.5	14.0	17.7	12.8	11.5	10.5	9.6	8.7
Equity FCF (UBS) yield %	6.2	5.5	4.1	6.6	7.7	8.6	9.8	11.1
Dividend yield (net) %	1.1	1.4	1.1	1.5	1.7	1.8	2.0	2.2

Source: Company accounts, LSEG Eikon, UBS estimates. Metrics marked as (UBS) have had analyst adjustments applied. Valuations: based on an average share price that year, (E): based on a share price of HK\$ 462.60 on 13-May-2026

reasons: **1) The company's core operations remain robust, underpinning its current valuation** (13x P/E, which is relatively low even for a gaming firm). Its online gaming segment offers strong visibility and is less susceptible to disruption from AI, ensuring a reliable cash flow to sustain its valuation even if AI monetization takes longer to materialize. **2) Management has adopted a more proactive approach to AI development, adding optionality to future growth.** Examples include the integration of the HY3.0 model into 131 internal products, with a larger model currently in development. Additionally, Capex has increased significantly to Rmb32bn (vs. Rmb19bn in 4Q25), and management anticipates accelerated cloud revenue growth in 2H. **3) Crucially, we believe AI is not a winner-takes-all market.** As long as Tencent possesses key assets such as talent, data, use cases, and a substantial user base, the company has room to catch up. Historical precedent from the U.S. demonstrates that late entrants can outperform incumbents in similar scenarios.

In the near term, with the stock trading at a five-year low of 13x P/E, Tencent's investment case is likely to be driven less by EPS changes but more by multiple re-rating, supported by the rollout of new AI-driven products over the next few quarters, such as HY4.0 or the Weixin agent. Overall, the AI industry is evolving at an exceptionally rapid pace. If the future landscape is characterized by first-mover advantages and winner take all dynamic, Alibaba appears to be better positioned to benefit. Conversely, if the market evolves in a more balanced manner, Tencent offers a more attractive risk-reward profile we believe. In addition, should market enthusiasm for AI moderate, Tencent's undemanding valuation offer stronger downside support, in our view.

Valuation: Undemanding at 13x 2026E P/E

Post earnings, we fine tune our earnings and maintain our PT at HK\$780.

Figure 1: 1Q26 result summary

(Rmb m)	1Q25	4Q25	1Q26	QoQ	YoY	Cons	+/-
a. VAS	92,133	89,920	96,110	6.9%	4.3%	100,698	-4.6%
Domestic games	42,933	38,220	45,410	18.8%	5.8%	47,628	-4.7%
International games	16,600	21,100	18,800	-10.9%	13.3%	19,516	-3.7%
Core social network	32,600	30,600	31,900	4.2%	-2.1%	33,610	-5.1%
b. Marketing services	31,853	41,116	38,171	-7.2%	19.8%	37,660	1.4%
c. Fintech & business services	54,907	60,818	59,885	-1.5%	9.1%	59,740	0.2%
d. Others	1,129	2,517	2,292	-8.9%	103.0%	1,351	69.7%
Total revenue	180,022	194,371	196,458	1.1%	9.1%	199,464	-1.5%
YoY % chg	12.9%	12.7%	9.1%			10.8%	-1.7%
Gross profit	100,493	108,289	111,265	2.7%	10.7%	112,596	-1.2%
YoY % chg	19.8%	19.5%	10.7%			12.0%	-1.3%
GPM %	55.8%	55.7%	56.6%	0.9pcts	0.8pcts	56.4%	0.2pcts
Value added services	59.6%	59.5%	62.6%	3.0pcts	3.0pcts	60.4%	2.1pcts
Marketing services	55.5%	59.7%	55.0%	-4.7pcts	-0.6pcts	57.4%	-2.4pcts
Fintech and business services	50.3%	50.7%	52.1%	1.3pcts	1.8pcts	50.3%	1.8pcts
Others	25.8%	-26.5%	-44.9%	-18.4pcts	-70.6pcts	7.9%	-52.7pcts
Selling and marketing	(7,866)	(12,983)	(11,343)	-12.6%	44.2%	(11,075)	2.4%
General and administrative	(33,664)	(36,283)	(33,800)	-6.8%	0.4%	(37,198)	-9.1%
Non-GAAP operating profit	69,320	69,518	75,627	8.8%	9.1%	74,753	1.2%
Adj. OPM %	38.5%	35.8%	38.5%	2.7pcts	0.0pcts	37.5%	1.0pcts
YoY % chg	18.3%	16.9%	9.1%			7.8%	16.1%
Share of gains from associates and JVs	4,581	6,832	3,620	-47.0%	-21.0%	4,802	-24.6%
Income tax expense	(13,717)	(12,595)	(14,577)	15.7%	6.3%	(13,691)	6.5%
Non-GAAP net profit	61,329	64,694	67,905	5.0%	10.7%	67,782	0.2%
YoY % chg	22.0%	17.0%	10.7%			10.5%	0.2%
Adj. NPM %	34.1%	33.3%	34.6%	1.3pcts	0.5pcts	34.0%	0.6pcts

Source: Visible Alpha, Company data

Figure 2: Valuation

Business segment		Valuation (HK\$mn)	Per share (HK\$)	Mix (%)	Valuation methodology
<u>Core business</u>					
1)	PC games	582,037	63.6	9%	13x 2026E EBIT multiple
2)	Mobile games	1,830,902	200.1	29%	15x 2026E EBIT multiple
3)	Social and advertising (ex. video)	2,018,393	220.6	31%	15x 2026E EBIT multiple
4)	Video	11,348	1.2	0%	Market valuation
5)	Music	57,330	6.3	1%	Market valuation
6)	Fintech	661,913	72.3	10%	3x 2026E P/S
7)	Cloud	220,638	24.1	3%	4x 2026E P/S
Core business valuation		5,382,561	588.2	84%	
<u>Investment</u>					
	Listed associates	315,838	34.5	5%	Fair value as of 1Q26
	Unlisted associates	159,501	17.4	2%	1x reported book value as of 1Q26
	Financial assets - FVPL	226,536	24.8	4%	Fair value as of 1Q26
	Financial assets - FVOCI	323,234	35.3	5%	Fair value as of 1Q26
8)	Total investment portfolio	1,025,109	112.0	16%	
Target valuation		6,407,671	700		
Valuation (HK\$)		700	end-2025E		
Price target (HK\$)		780	end-May 27E		

Source: Company data, UBS estimates

Forecast returns

Forecast price appreciation	68.6%
Forecast dividend yield	1.5%
Forecast stock return	70.1%
Market return assumption	10.9%
Forecast excess return	59.2%

Company Description

Tencent has the largest online community in China. It was founded with the launch of instant messaging platform QQ but has since grown into a diversified internet company with core focuses on gaming, social media and networking (Weixin/WeChat), fintech (WeChat Pay), cloud computing and digital content. The company also holds a substantial investment portfolio of public and private companies.

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

Our price target is based on sum of the parts.

We believe the key risks for Tencent include: 1) an evolving and intensifying competitive landscape; 2) new business execution; 3) integration of invested companies and businesses; 4) rising costs of traffic acquisition, content and brand promotions; 5) IT system upkeep; 6) expansion into international markets; 7) infringement of intellectual property rights; 8) departures of key management; and 9) regulatory risks.

Alibaba Group:

Our price target is based on SOTP.

We believe the key risks for Alibaba are: 1) regulatory changes, particularly for data usage and online content; 2) Chinese and global macroeconomic headwinds; 3) competitive pressure from traditional offline retailers; 4) interruptions of information technology and systems; 5) short-term profitability pressure from long-term investment; 6) execution and management complexity resulting from its multiple platforms; 7) corporate governance – significant voting control by the Alibaba Partnership; and 8) the loss of the services of founder Jack Ma.

Quantitative Research Review

UBS Global Research publishes a quantitative assessment of its analysts' responses to certain questions about the likelihood of an occurrence of a number of short term factors in a product known as the 'Quantitative Research Review'. The views for this month can be found below. Views contained in this assessment on a particular stock reflect only the views on those short term factors which are a different timeframe to the 12-month timeframe reflected in any equity rating set out in this note. For previous responses please make reference to (i) previous UBS Global Research reports; and (ii) where no applicable research report was published that month, the Quantitative Research Review which can be found at <https://neo.ubs.com/quantitative>, or contact your UBS sales representative for access to the report or the Quantitative Research Team on ubs-quant-answers@ubs.com. A consolidated report which contains all responses is also available and again you should contact your UBS sales representative for details and pricing or the Quantitative Research Team on the email above.

Tencent Holdings

Question	Response
1. Is the industry structure facing the firm likely to improve or deteriorate over the next six months? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting worse, 3 = no change, 5 = getting better, N/A = no view)	4
2. Is the regulatory/government environment facing the firm likely to improve or deteriorate over the next six months? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting tougher, 3 = no change, 5 = getting better, N/A = no view)	3
3. Over the last 3-6 months in broad terms have things been improving/no change/getting worse for this stock? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting a lot worse, 3 = not much change, 5 = getting a lot better, N/A = no view)	4
4. Relative to the current CONSENSUS EPS forecast, is the next company EPS update likely to lead to: (1 = negative surprise vs consensus, 3 = in-line with consensus, 5 = positive surprise vs consensus expectations, N/A = no view)	4
5. What's driving the difference?	
6. Relative to YOUR current earnings forecast, is there relatively greater risk at the next earnings result of: (1 = downside skew risk to earnings, 3 = equal upside or downside risk to earnings, 5 = upside skew risk to earnings, N/A = no view)	3
7. What's driving the difference?	
8. Is there an upcoming catalyst for the company over the next three months?	No Catalyst
9. Is there an actual or approximate date for the catalyst?	
10. Is the catalyst date an actual or approximate date?	
11. What is the catalyst?	

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12-Month Rating	Definition	Coverage ¹	IB Services ²
Buy	FSR is > 6% above the MRA.	54%	24%
Neutral	FSR is between -6% and 6% of the MRA.	40%	21%
Sell	FSR is > 6% below the MRA.	6%	21%

Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 31 March 2026.

1:Percentage of companies under coverage globally within the 12-month rating category.

2:Percentage of companies within the 12-month rating category for which investment banking (IB) services were provided within the past 12 months.

KEY DEFINITIONS:**Forecast Stock Return (FSR)** is defined as expected percentage price appreciation plus gross dividend yield over the next 12 months. In some cases, this yield may be based on accrued dividends. **Market Return Assumption (MRA)** is defined as the one-year local market interest rate plus 5% (a proxy for, and not a forecast of, the equity risk premium). **Under Review (UR)** Stocks may be flagged as UR by the analyst, indicating that the stock's price target and/or rating are subject to possible change in the near term, usually in response to an event that may affect the investment case or valuation. **Equity Price Targets** have an investment horizon of 12 months.

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Company Disclosures

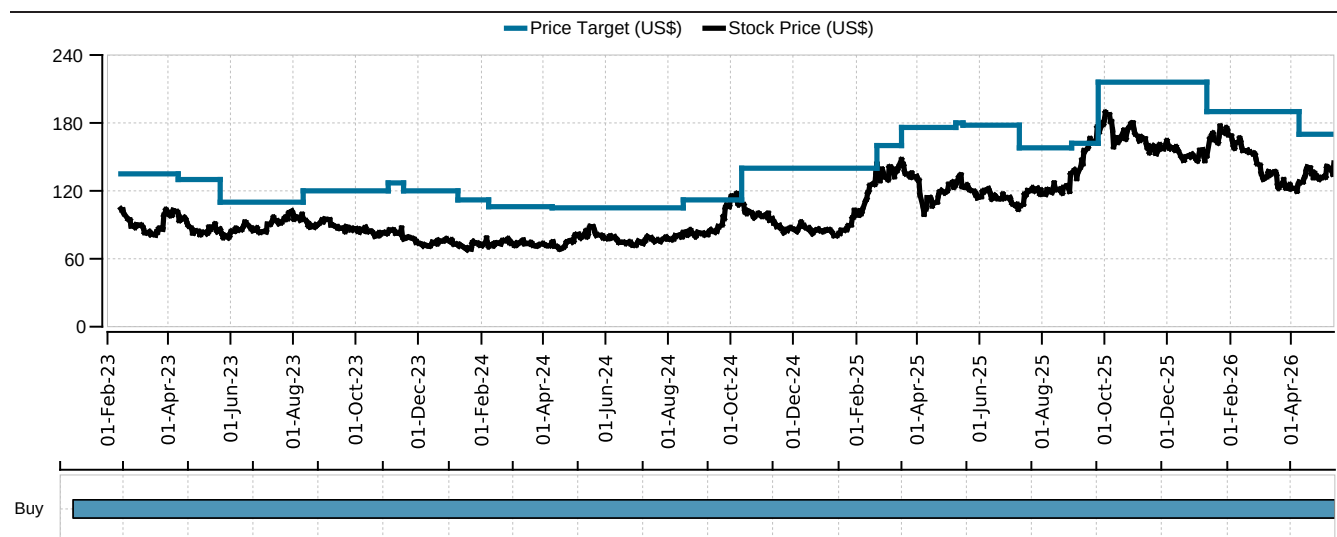
Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
Alibaba Group ^{2,3,4,28,7,6a,6b,16a,16b}	BABA.N	Buy	US\$144.62	13 May 2026
Tencent Holdings ^{28,16a}	0700.HK	Buy	HK\$462.60	13 May 2026

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon. All prices as of local market close. Ratings in this table are the most current published ratings prior to this report. They may be more recent than the stock pricing date.

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Alibaba Group (US\$)

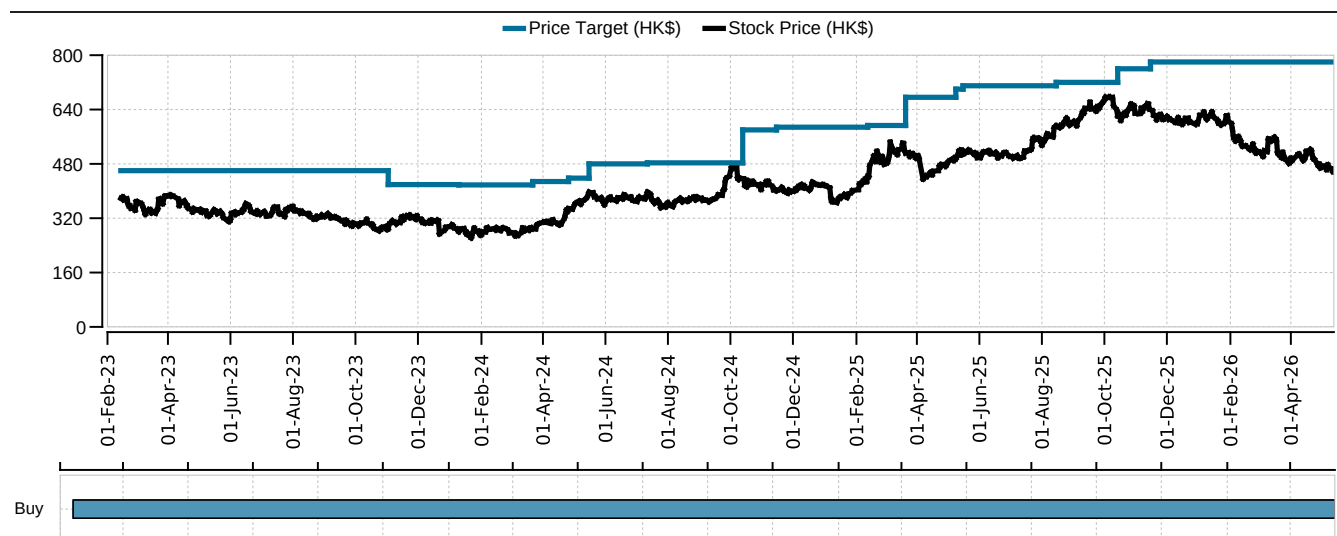


Date	Stock Price (US\$)	Price Target (US\$)	Rating
2023-02-13	104.79	135.00	Buy
2023-04-10	101.54	130.00	Buy
2023-05-21	83.98	110.00	Buy
2023-08-10	99.21	120.00	Buy
2023-11-01	82.48	127.00	Buy
2023-11-16	79.11	120.00	Buy
2024-01-08	72.88	112.00	Buy
2024-02-07	73.64	106.00	Buy

Date	Stock Price (US\$)	Price Target (US\$)	Rating
2024-04-09	72.99	105.00	Buy
2024-08-15	79.54	112.00	Buy
2024-10-11	110.14	140.00	Buy
2025-02-20	135.97	160.00	Buy
2025-03-16	141.10	176.00	Buy
2025-05-08	125.79	180.00	Buy
2025-05-15	123.90	178.00	Buy
2025-07-09	103.83	158.00	Buy
2025-08-29	135.00	162.00	Buy
2025-09-24	176.44	216.00	Buy
2026-01-08	154.47	190.00	Buy
2026-04-08	125.32	170.00	Buy
2026-05-13	144.62	184.00	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 13-May-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

Tencent Holdings (HK\$)



Date	Stock Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)	Rating
2023-02-13	386.60	460.00	Buy
2023-11-01	287.00	419.00	Buy
2024-01-09	283.60	418.00	Buy
2024-03-21	291.20	428.00	Buy
2024-04-25	339.40	438.00	Buy
2024-05-15	381.80	480.00	Buy
2024-07-11	384.80	483.00	Buy
2024-10-12	438.80	580.00	Buy
2024-11-14	403.40	588.00	Buy
2025-02-11	427.40	593.00	Buy
2025-03-20	519.50	676.00	Buy
2025-05-08	498.00	700.00	Buy
2025-05-15	520.00	710.00	Buy
2025-08-14	590.00	720.00	Buy
2025-10-13	639.00	760.00	Buy
2025-11-14	641.00	780.00	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 13-May-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

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